

# Nimbus Commerce — Order Merge and Consolidation Policy

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Purpose: This document defines the rules for customers who want two or more separate Nimbus Commerce orders to be combined into one shipment after checkout. It introduces a distinct operational scenario for retrieval testing and should be treated independently from return, cancellation, address-change, partial-shipment, and standard delivery policies.

## 1. Scope

Order consolidation is an optional warehouse-handling request. It does not convert multiple orders into a single commercial order, invoice, payment transaction, loyalty transaction, or return record. Each original order keeps its own order number and financial history.

## 2. When a Merge Request May Be Submitted

A customer may request consolidation when all candidate orders satisfy the following conditions:

| Condition   | Requirement                                                                |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fulfillment | All orders must be fulfilled by Nimbus Commerce's own warehouse network.   |
| Warehouse   | Orders must currently be assigned to the same fulfillment center.          |
| Status      | Every order must be paid and not yet handed to a carrier.                  |
| Destination | Shipping address must match exactly at the order-record level.             |
| Packaging   | No order may already have entered final packing or carrier-label creation. |

## 3. Cases That Must Not Be Consolidated

Support must reject the merge request if any candidate order is seller-fulfilled, already manifested to a carrier, assigned to different warehouses, placed on fraud-review hold, contains a regulated shipping restriction, or has a destination mismatch. Orders containing digital-only products are also excluded because they do not enter the physical shipment workflow.

## 4. What Consolidation Changes

If warehouse operations approve the request, eligible physical items may be packed together under one shipping container. The system records the consolidation event against every participating order. Original order totals, tax calculations, coupon applications, payment authorizations, and item-level identifiers remain unchanged.

The customer should not be told that the orders have been 'merged into one order.' The approved wording is that the orders have been 'consolidated for shipment.' This distinction is important because future returns, refunds, warranty claims, and invoices continue to reference the originating order.

## 5. Shipping Charge Treatment

Consolidation does not automatically recalculate shipping fees. Existing shipping charges remain attached to their original orders unless a separate shipping-credit rule explicitly authorizes an adjustment. Agents must not promise a refund of duplicate shipping charges merely because two parcels are physically packed together.

## 6. Timing and Warehouse Cutoff

A merge request is operationally valid only before the earliest participating order crosses the warehouse packing cutoff. If the request arrives after cutoff but before carrier pickup, support should explain that the orders can no longer be consolidated. The orders should continue through their normal fulfillment paths.

## 7. Support Workflow

| Step | Agent action                                                                                                     |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Collect every order number the customer wants consolidated.                                                      |
| 2    | Check fulfillment method, warehouse assignment, payment state, destination, and packing state.                   |
| 3    | Confirm that none of the exclusion conditions applies.                                                           |
| 4    | Submit a warehouse consolidation request; do not manually alter order records.                                   |
| 5    | Tell the customer that consolidation is pending until warehouse confirmation is received.                        |
| 6    | After confirmation, communicate the shipment relationship without describing the orders as one commercial order. |

## 8. Customer Communication Examples

**Eligible request:** 'Your orders meet the current consolidation conditions. I can submit a warehouse request to have the physical items packed together. The request remains pending until the warehouse confirms it.'

**Rejected request:** 'These orders cannot be consolidated because they are currently assigned to different fulfillment centers. They will continue through their existing fulfillment processes.'

**Do not say:** 'I merged your orders, so you now have one order and one invoice.' That statement is incorrect under this policy.

## 9. Retrieval-Test Notes

Key retrieval concepts intentionally specific to this document include: shipment consolidation, warehouse assignment matching, final-packing cutoff, commercial-order identity, consolidation event, duplicate shipping-charge treatment, and physical-versus-digital fulfillment eligibility.

This policy is synthetic and belongs to the fictional Nimbus Commerce support corpus. It is intended for RAG insertion, retrieval evaluation, and agent-policy testing.